



FTC sides with Right to Repair

FTC report finds scant evidence to support manufacturer's anti-repair stance.
<http://dgit.in/may21-62>



Sonova buys Sennheiser

Not all but Sennheiser's consumer electronics division has been bought by Sonova. <http://dgit.in/may21-63>

Sony SRS-RA3000

Immersive audio with some hitches

At the Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2020, Sony launched premium speakers with its 360 Reality Audio technology, differentiating them from what was already on the market. The company has now launched the Sony SRS-RA3000 and Sony SRS-RA5000, boasting of this technology, in India. Here's how the former fared in our review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Sony SRS-RA3000 has a rather imposing build being almost 10 inches tall and weighing a whopping 2.5 kg. Nevertheless, this is a wired speaker so it's something you would set up and forget. Even if you do move it, the speaker auto-calibrates itself and it can also adjust volume automatically according to the track that's playing, to ensure that it's not too loud or quiet.

The speaker is pretty classy and elegant to look at. It comes with a fabric finish that contrasts against the copper-coloured grilles. Sony also claims that the speaker is humidity resistant but there's no official IP rating attached to it.

On the top of the speaker, you have a touch panel that houses the speaker's controls. There's also an Immersive Audio Enhancement button that changes the sound profile of the speaker significantly and fires music from the floor to the ceiling to provide a more immersive sonic experience. At the back of the speaker, you have an Audio In jack and a power jack.

You can connect the speaker via Bluetooth, Wi-Fi (Chromecast built-in) or you could simply connect the speaker via an AUX cable.

FEATURES

The speaker also comes packing Sony's 360 Reality Audio technology that can play supported tracks by



incorporating three-dimensional sound location data to deliver room-filling, immersive audio. Unfortunately, there is only one 360 Reality Audio platform available as of now, and it's paid.

While the Sony SRS-RA3000 is not a smart speaker by itself, the device can be set up alongside an Echo or Google Nest device to give it some smart brains. Additionally, the speakers can also be set up via Google Home to connect to a Spotify account and pair multiple speakers together.

There's also Sony's Music Center accompanying app that allows users to tweak EQ settings and configure Alexa and Google Assistant voice control.

PERFORMANCE

When it comes to hardware, the Sony SRS-RA3000 packs two 17 mm tweeters alongside a full-range 80 mm speaker and two passive radiators. The speaker supports SBC and AAC audio codecs. We pri-

marily tested the speaker in normal stereo mode and Immersive Audio Enhancement Mode. We did try 360 Reality Audio and the results were pretty impressive, with the sound-stage being full and dynamic.

With Immersive Audio Enhancement Mode, we found the performance to be slightly polarising. The speaker certainly emits room-filling audio with a wide soundscape, but the bass does get boomy, especially at higher volumes. Also, there's a certain lack of clarity in comparison to regular stereo listening. It definitely makes more sense to use this mode when watching TV shows and movies rather than listening to music.

In the regular stereo setting, the speaker delivers clean, crisp vocals, well-rounded bass response, and pleasant highs. We found the sound-stage to be more open and the details were even more prominent. The sound quality in this mode was quite delightful irrespective of the genre of music we played. The bass response is still slightly dominating, but it allows the other frequencies to flourish.

VERDICT

Overall, the Sony SRS-RA3000 is a well-built, feature-laden wired speaker that offers a lot for its price. It even competes with Amazon Echo or Google Home speakers due to its ability to morph into a voice-controlled speaker when connected to a smart speaker.

—Dhriti Datta

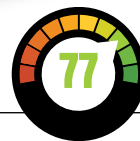
SPECIFICATIONS

NUMBER OF SPEAKERS: Tweeter Unit 2, Full-range 1, Passive Radiator 2 | SPEAKER SIZE: Tweeter Unit 17 mm, Full-range 80 mm, Passive Radiator 103 x 37 (mm) | 360 REALITY AUDIO: Yes | DIGITAL SOUND ENHANCEMENT ENGINE: Yes | AUTO VOLUME: Yes | AUTO SOUND CALIBRATION: Yes | DIMENSIONS (W x H x D): 146 x 247 x 155 mm | WEIGHT: 2.5 kg | SUPPORTED CODECS: SBC, AAC | Power consumption: 20 W

CONTACT

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Price
₹19,990



BUILD	84
FEATURES	75
PERFORMANCE	74
VALUE	74